NORTHBANK MEDIA LAB · SOCIAL LISTENING REPORT

Signal & Noise 2026

How social media talked about LLMs, Jan–Sep 2026

20%
agentic coding's share of the conversation in Sep (Jan: 9%)

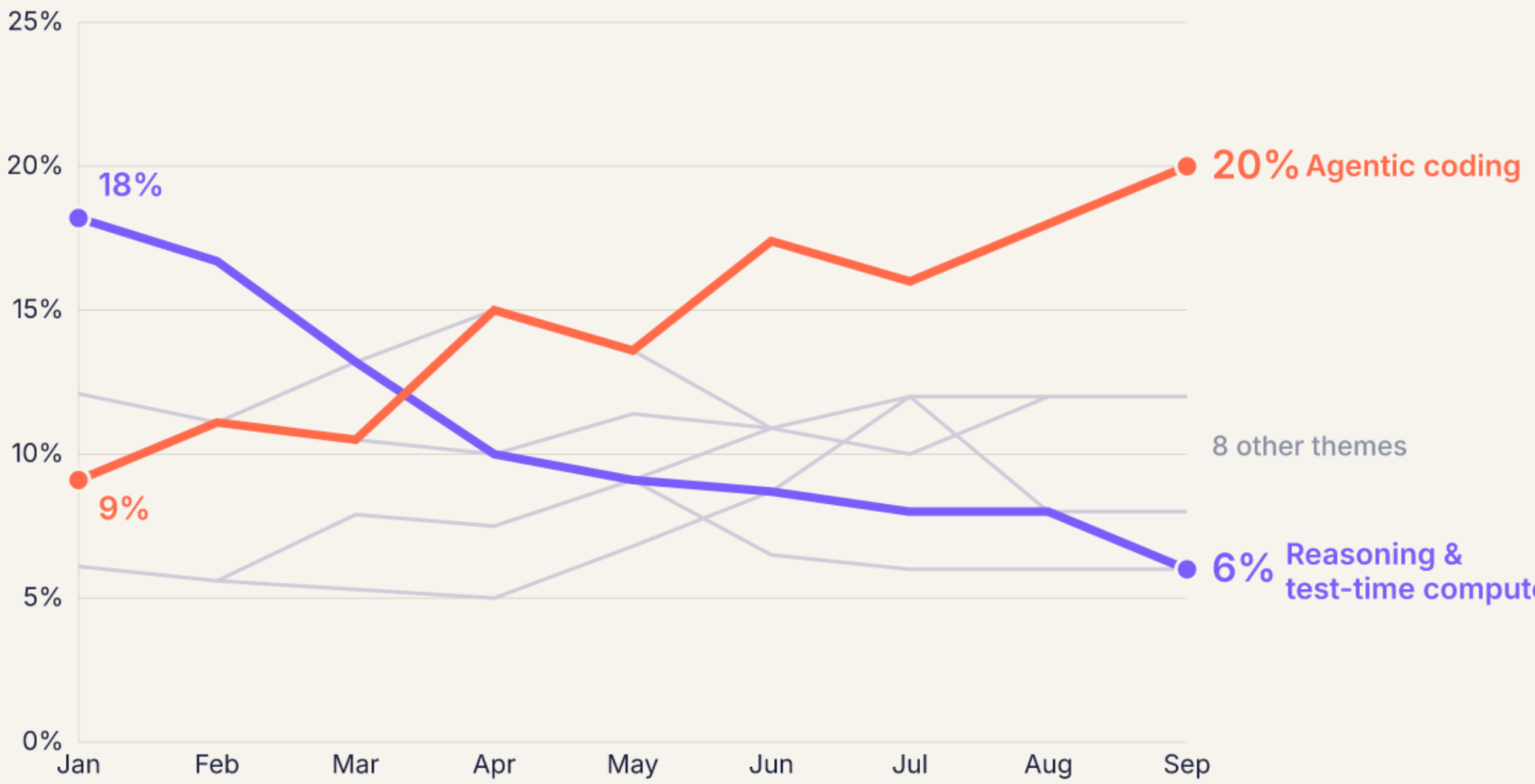
6%
reasoning's share of the conversation in Sep (Jan: 18%)

53%
of price & token posts were negative (all themes: 23%)

387
hand-coded sample posts from 6 platforms

Agentic coding doubled its share

Share of the conversation per theme and month, in a hand-coded sample of 387 posts.



COOLING

Reasoning & test-time compute fell from 18% to 6% of the conversation.

GROWING

Compute & energy and multimodal & voice grew from 9% to 12% each.

SPIKE

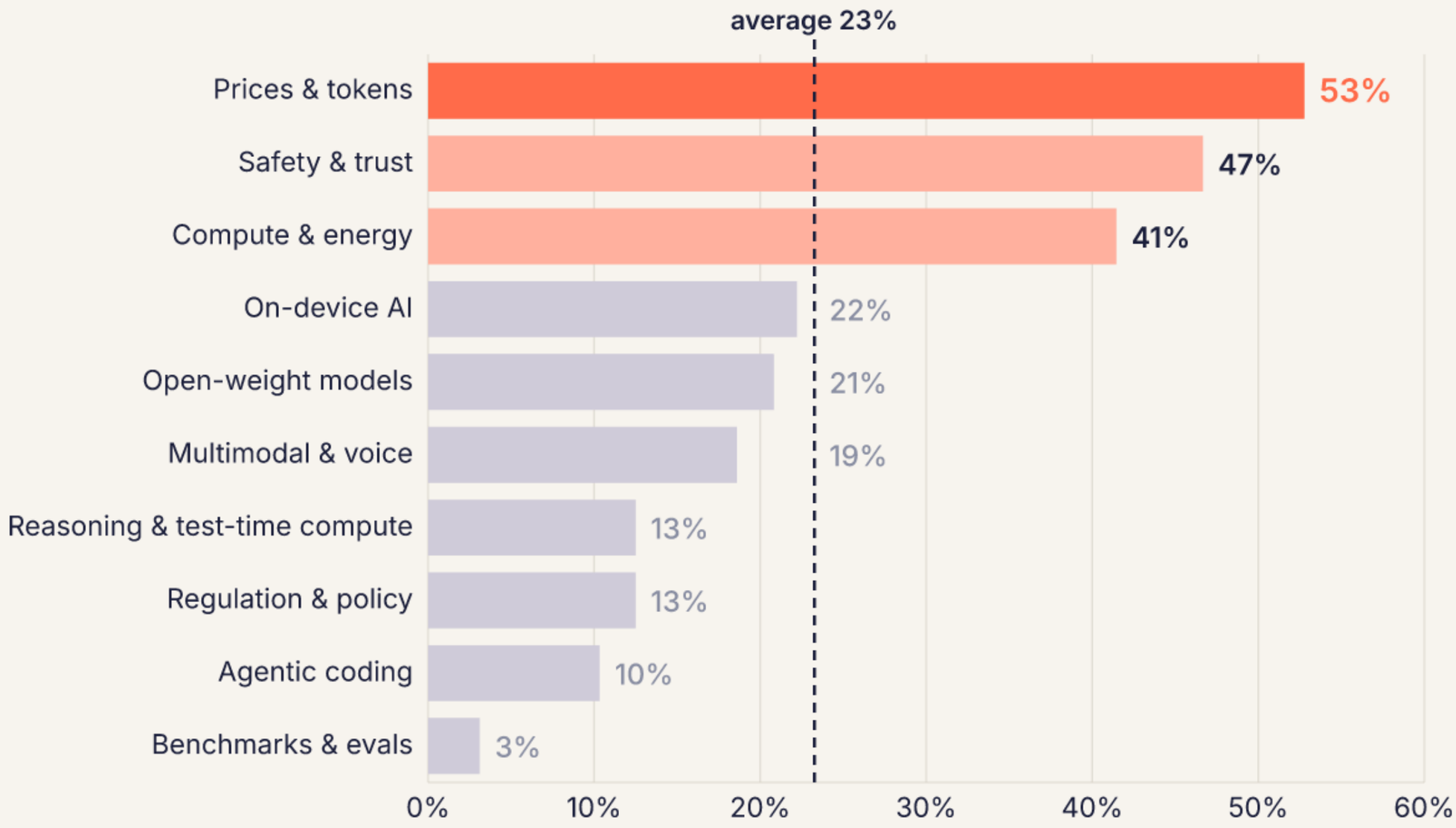
Regulation & policy peaked in July at 12% of the conversation.

Illustrative study. The data is a synthetic, hand-coded sample of 387 posts by fictional @researcher handles. It represents a much larger stream. There are no real quotes or release claims. Layout: DesignCraft. Charts and badge: VectorCraft.

SIGNAL & NOISE 2026 · PART 2

Negative posts by theme

Share of each theme's posts that were negative, Jan–Sep 2026. The average for all themes is 23%.



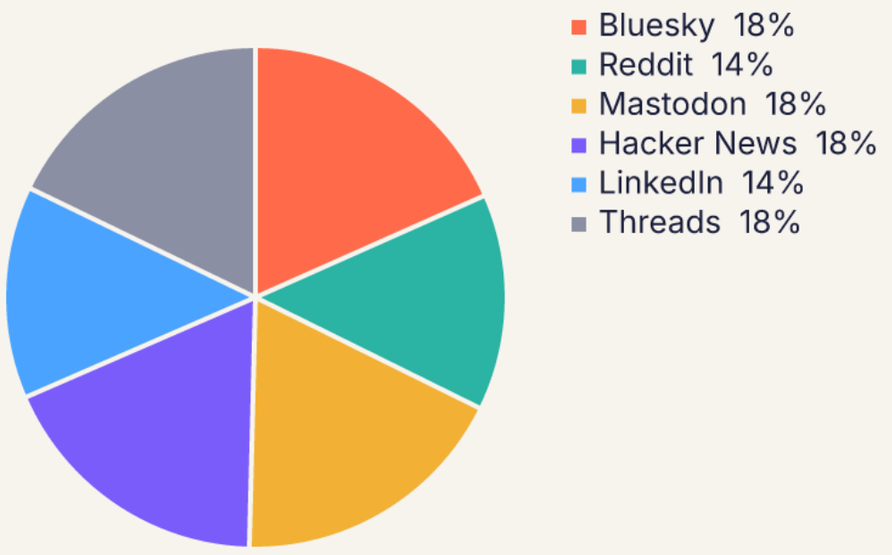
53% of Prices & tokens posts were negative. This is more than 2 times the 23% average. A frequent complaint: “price per token down, bill up.”

ALSO MORE NEGATIVE THAN AVERAGE

Safety & trust (47%) and Compute & energy (41%) are also much more negative than average.

Benchmarks & evals is the least negative theme (3%).

SAMPLE BY PLATFORM



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